

Love: Giving 'Til It Hurts

Do you believe the expression, “You can’t buy love”? Some people use their wealth to attract friends or even the person they will marry. The allure of money is very difficult for some to resist. People can even talk themselves into marrying someone whom they are not attracted to, all for the love of money.

Eventually, the reality of a loveless marriage or fake friendship surfaces and no amount of money will make the charade worth it any longer. Using money as a way to attract others or make them love you often indicates a person with low self-esteem. They do not believe that someone could actually love them for who they are; they can only be loved for what they have.

Another way that money and love go together is in the genuine desire to give to others who you care for to make their lives easier. It feels good to share your good fortune with your friends and family who are struggling financially. The joy you get out of this charitable act is rewarding.

It is fine to give for love as long as you do not forget the lesson learned in the previous chapter, giving too much. It becomes too much when you are continually bailing out someone or if your standard of living becomes drastically reduced, not having enough money left over for your own needs.

The important distinction to remember in using money for love is that money can never take the place of love. It can be used to enhance your love, but not as a substitute. If Ben’s dad Charles had understood this difference, he hopefully would have avoided the financial crisis this belief caused him.

Ben’s parents had been divorced for three years. He was a freshman in high school when his dad Charles first moved out. Ben missed his dad since under the custody arrangement he saw his father only every other weekend. His mother Susan seemed to relish the fact that she was developing a much

